

Reviewer Pack — Minimal Rank of Quasipolynomial Functions vs DPLL Refutation...

Entry 0f9459f83f8d · INCONCLUSIVE

SEC autonomous research engine — attribution: Ludovico Kubler

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Minimal Rank of Quasipolynomial Functions vs DPLL Refutation Tree Diameter

Entry ID: 0f9459f83f8d **Verdict:** INCONCLUSIVE **Recorded:** 2026-05-24 11:36:14 UTC

1. Conjecture

Field A (mathematical branch): Quasi-Polynomial Functions **Field B** (complexity object): Complexity Theory (DPLL Refutation Complexity)

Statement:

[‘For all n variable CNF formulas, the minimal rank of a quasipolynomial function representing the truth table is at least as large as the diameter of the DPLL refutation tree.’, ‘Equivalently, for any CNF formula F , if there exists a quasipolynomial function g such that F ’s truth table is represented by g , then the diameter of the corresponding DPLL refutation tree $T(F)$ satisfies: $\text{rank}(g) \geq \text{diameter}(T(F))$.’, ‘Furthermore, this bound holds with respect to polynomial reductions.’]

Rationale (proposer’s reasoning):

[‘Quasi-polynomial functions have been studied in complexity theory as a bridge between polynomial and exponential complexities. Their ranks could potentially reveal structural properties of the DPLL refutation trees, which are central to understanding proof complexity.’, ‘If true, this conjecture would provide a new perspective on proof complexity by connecting it with the algebraic properties of quasipolynomial functions.’, ‘Moreover, it could lead to new algorithms for solving satisfiability problems if such a connection can be exploited.’]

Taxonomy category: SOS_DEGREE (status at proposal time:)

2. Pre-registration (Popper-style)

Hash (SHA-256 prefix): 83faf1bb115be13d

This hash commits to the conjecture statement, acceptance criterion, and seed list **before** the empirical test runs. Tampering with the test or its data after this hash was computed would be detectable.

Acceptance criterion:

For a given n variable CNF formula, if the minimal rank of a quasipolynomial function representing its truth table is at least as large as the diameter of the DPLL refutation tree by at least 3 standard deviations from the mean over all 30 seeds.

3. Barrier filter (F1)

Final: PASS

Barrier	Verdict	Confidence	LLM ₁	LLM ₂
RELATIVIZATION	UNCERTAIN	1.00	SAFE	HITS
NATURAL_PROOFS	SAFE	0.50	UNCERTAIN	UNCERTAIN
ALGEBRIZATION	UNCERTAIN	0.90	UNCERTAIN	HITS
KARP_LIPTON	SAFE	0.50	UNCERTAIN	UNCERTAIN

4. Novelty audit

Verdict: NOVEL against 6 hits across arXiv + Semantic Scholar + ECCC

Search queries (3): - quasi-polynomial functions and DPLL refutation complexity - minimal rank of quasipolynomial functions in relation to DPLL tree diameter - DPLL refutation tree diameter comparison with quasipolynomial function ranks

Top relevant hits considered: - [http://arxiv.org/abs/cs/0209032v3] Complexity Results on DPLL and Resolution - [http://arxiv.org/abs/2404.04038v1] Refutability as Recursive as Provability - [http://arxiv.org/abs/1701.07208v2] A Quasi-Polynomial Approximation for the Restricted Assignment Problem - [http://arxiv.org/abs/1605.08266v2] A CFSG-free analysis of Babai's quasipolynomial GI-algorithm - [http://arxiv.org/abs/1204.1444v2] Computing the minimum rank of a loop directed tree - [http://arxiv.org/abs/2507.15986v1] On the reconstruction of trees from their chromatic symmetric functions

5. Empirical test harness

Multi-seed protocol: 5 seeds (11, 23, 37, 53, 71)

Sandbox: isolated subprocess, stdlib-only, ≤90s wall time per cycle **Execution:** rc=1, elapsed=0.1s

5.1 Generated Python source

```
import random
import math
from fractions import Fraction

# Helper functions for matrix operations
def gaussian_elimination(A):
    m, n = len(A), len(A[0])
    rank = 0
    for j in range(n):
        i_max = rank
        for i in range(rank, m):
            if abs(A[i][j]) > abs(A[i_max][j]):
                i_max = i
        if A[i_max][j] == 0:
            continue
        A[rank], A[i_max] = A[i_max], A[rank]
        for i in range(m):
            if i != rank and A[i][j] != 0:
                factor = -A[i][j] / A[rank][j]
                for k in range(n):
                    A[i][k] += factor * A[rank][k]
        rank += 1
```

```

    return rank

def matrix_multiplication(A, B):
    m, n, p = len(A), len(B), len(B[0])
    C = [[0] * p for _ in range(m)]
    for i in range(m):
        for k in range(p):
            for j in range(n):
                C[i][k] += A[i][j] * B[j][k]
    return C

def rank_of_matrix(A):
    return gaussian_elimination(A)

# Function to generate a random n-variable CNF formula
def generate_cnf(num_vars, num_clauses):
    cnf = []
    for _ in range(num_clauses):
        clause = set()
        while len(clause) < 3:
            var = random.randint(1, num_vars)
            sign = random.choice([True, False])
            if (var, sign) not in clause and (-var, not sign) not in clause:
                clause.add((var, sign))
        cnf.append(clause)
    return cnf

# Function to compute the truth table of a CNF formula
def truth_table(cnf, num_vars):
    n = 2 ** num_vars
    tt = [[False] * n for _ in range(len(cnf))]
    for i in range(n):
        assignment = [(i >> j) & 1 == 1 for j in range(num_vars)]
        for clause in cnf:
            if all((assignment[var - 1] if sign else not assignment[var - 1]) for var, sign in clause):
                tt[len(cnf) - 1][i] = True
                break
    return tt

# Function to construct the DPLL refutation tree and calculate its diameter
def dpll_refutation_tree(cnf, num_vars):
    def dpll(clause_set, assignment):
        if not clause_set:
            return [assignment]
        unit_clause = next((c for c in clause_set if len(c) == 1), None)
        if unit_clause:
            var, sign = unit_clause[0]
            new_assignment = assignment[:]
            new_assignment[var - 1] = sign
            return dpll(clause_set - {unit_clause}, new_assignment)
        pure_literal = next((v for v in range(1, num_vars + 1) if (v not in [abs(x) for x in assignment])), None)
        if pure_literal:
            sign = True
            new_assignment = assignment[:]
            new_assignment[pure_literal - 1] = sign
            return dpll(clause_set, new_assignment)
    return dpll(cnf, assignment)

```

```

    var = next((v for v in range(1, num_vars + 1) if v not in [abs(x) for x in assignment]), None)
    true_branch = dpll(clause_set, assignment + [(var, True)])
    false_branch = dpll(clause_set, assignment + [(var, False)])
    return true_branch + false_branch

refutation_tree = dpll(set(cnf), [])
edges = []
for node in refutation_tree:
    for other_node in refutation_tree:
        if node != other_node and any(abs(x) not in [abs(y) for y in node] for x in other_node):
            edges.append((node, other_node))
return len(refutation_tree), max(len(list(bfs(edges, start))) - 1 for start in refutation_tree)

def bfs(edges, start):
    visited = set()
    queue = [start]
    while queue:
        node = queue.pop(0)
        if node not in visited:
            visited.add(node)
            neighbors = {neighbor for neighbor, _ in edges if neighbor == node}
            queue.extend(neighbors - visited)
    return visited

def run_trial(seed: int) -> dict:
    random.seed(seed)
    num_vars = 5
    num_clauses = 10
    cnf = generate_cnf(num_vars, num_clauses)
    tt = truth_table(cnf, num_vars)
    rank = rank_of_matrix(tt)
    _, diameter = dpll_refutation_tree(cnf, num_vars)

    if rank < diameter:
        return {
            "metric_name": "rank vs diameter",
            "metric_value": rank,
            "instances_tested": 1,
            "conjecture_holds": False,
            "counterexample": f"Rank {rank} < Diameter {diameter}"
        }

    return {
        "metric_name": "rank vs diameter",
        "metric_value": rank,
        "instances_tested": 1,
        "conjecture_holds": True,
        "counterexample": ""
    }

if __name__ == "__main__":
    import sys
    seeds = [int(x) for x in sys.argv[1:]] or [2, 3, 5, 7, 11, 13, 17, 19, 23, 29] * 3
    results = []

    for seed in seeds:

```

```

    result = run_trial(seed)
    print(f"TRIAL: {result}")
    results.append(result)

mean_value = sum(r["metric_value"] for r in results) / len(results)
std_value = math.sqrt(sum((r["metric_value"] - mean_value) ** 2 for r in results) / len(results))
support_fraction = sum(1 for r in results if r["conjecture_holds"]) / len(results)

if all(r["conjecture_holds"] for r in results):
    print(f"RESULT: SUPPORTED mean={mean_value:.4f} std={std_value:.4f} support_fraction={support_fraction:.4f}")
elif support_fraction >= 0.8:
    print(f"RESULT: SUPPORTED mean={mean_value:.4f} std={std_value:.4f} support_fraction={support_fraction:.4f}")
else:
    first_failing_seed = next((r["seed"] for r in results if not r["conjecture_holds"]), None)
    print(f"RESULT: FALSIFIED counterexample=\"rank < diameter\" first_failing_seed={first_failing_seed}")

```

6. Per-seed results

(no seed-level data — test crashed before producing TRIAL: lines)

7. Test stdout (last 2KB)

```

--STDERR--
Traceback (most recent call last):
  File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_7e8faabf.py", line 148, in <module>
    result = run_trial(seed)
              ~~~~~^
  File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_7e8faabf.py", line 123, in run_trial
    _, diameter = dpll_refutation_tree(cnf, num_vars)
                  ~~~~~^
  File "/home/ludo/Scrivania/SEC/research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_7e8faabf.py", line 97, in dpll_refutation_tree
    refutation_tree = dpll(set(cnf), [])
                        ~~~~~^
TypeError: unhashable type: 'set'

```

8. Critic adversarial review

Critic verdict: CHALLENGE

Critic reasoning:

skipped: test crashed before producing data

9. Final verdict & safety rail

Verdict: INCONCLUSIVE

Reasoning:

The test code crashed before producing data, which means that the pre-registered support condition could not be verified. | next: Investigate the cause of the crash and attempt to run the test again to verify the conjecture.

11. Audit log (LLM calls)

Total LLM calls: 10

#	Phase	Provider	Model	Tokens in	out	Latency (ms)
1	propose	ollama_remote	glm4:latest	0	0	12440
2	propose	ollama_remote	glm4:latest	0	0	10756
3	preregistration	ollama_remote	glm4:latest	0	0	6341
4	novelty	ollama_remote	glm4:latest	0	0	4936
5	novelty	ollama_remote	glm4:latest	0	0	6043
6	test_gen	ollama_remote	qwen2.5-coder:7b	0	0	24310
7	test_gen	ollama_remote	qwen2.5-coder:7b	0	0	12553
8	test_gen	ollama_remote	qwen2.5-coder:7b	0	0	11202
9	test_gen	ollama_remote	qwen2.5-coder:7b	0	0	17995
10	judge	ollama_remote	glm4:latest	0	0	8280

Totals: 0 input tokens, 0 output tokens, ~\$0.0000 cost, 114857 ms total latency. Provider mix: {'ollama_remote': 10}

(full prompt+response transcripts available in `research/audit/0f9459f83f8d.jsonl`)

12. Reproducibility

To reproduce this cycle:

1. Apply the test harness in section 5.1 with seeds 11,23,37,53,71
2. The Python sandbox is pure-stdlib; any Python 3.11+ should suffice
3. The full LLM transcripts are in `research/audit/0f9459f83f8d.jsonl` for verification of provenance
4. The pre-registration hash in section 2 commits to the test design before execution; tampering would be detectable.

Sandbox file: `research/pvsnp_sandbox/test_*.py` (per-cycle)

Replay tarball: `research/replay/0f9459f83f8d.tar.gz` (if generated)